# BETHANY LUTHERAN CHURCH

Minstry Team
Pastor Susan Dollinger : pastor@bethanylongview.org
Church Musician Dorothy McMillan
Administrative Assistant Ginger Garner: secretary@bethanylongview.org




2900 Parkview Dr. Longview, WA 98632
360-577-8240

**OFFICE HOURS**

Tuesday-Thursday
9:30-3:00

**SUNDAY WORSHIP**

Services 9:30
Coffee Hour 10:30




*28 Come to me all of you who are tired. You are like people who have worked for a long time. You are like people who have carried heavy things. Come to me. If you do that, you will find a place to rest. 29 Do what I teach you to do. Listen to my message and learn from me what is true. I am very kind and I do not make myself important. I will help you. Then you will have peace in your mind. 30 I will not tell you to do things that are too difficult. I will not tell you to carry anything that is too heavy for you.'*
*Matthew 11:28-30 (Easy English Bible Version).*

Dear Bethany, I read through many versions of this particular verse during this summer. It was a very relaxing exercise that spanned over a few days. The term "Let go and Let God" is not in the Bible but this verse seems fairly close to that concept. Give God your burdens and take the yoke he has to offer. A yoke is a contraption that put two animals together to steer a wagon or pull a load. Jesus was basically telling the people to watch out for the yoke of the pharisees which was heavy burdened with laws and rituals and to take up the yoke of Christ which held freedom and saving power.
When animals are yoked together, it takes less pressure off of one animal to carry the load. Before the crucifixion, a man named Simon of Cyrene helps Jesus carry his cross. So even Jesus had help when he needed.
We don't need to bear the weight of the world alone. We can give our burdens to Jesus, yoking ourselves to Christ is also a way of surrendering; saying, "I can't do it all on my own, Lord, I am ready to take your yoke for I know within it you will guide my steps and shoulder the weight of my burdens. I am yours."

In peace, Pastor Susan

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# Prayer Requests

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Deone Munn | Susan Shiu | Peggy Winston |
| Carol Lane | Karen Langworthy | June White |
| Barb Clausen | Judy Bailey | John Mullaney |
| Barbara Price | Gail Obermeyer | Jennifer Nance |
| Custer family | Gilchrist family | Bob Baldwin |
| Krista & John Croy | Thibodeau family | The Milhisers |
| Takko family | David & Dana Hughes | The Newtons |

Shelly Limpach is our prayer chain contact. You may contact her with your prayer concerns through email at BethanyPrayer247@gmail.com . If you have an urgent prayer request, please call the church office.

## Emergency Fund August: Columbia Heights and Lexington Thanksgiving Food Boxes

In order not to overload us for the holidays, the Youth & Service Committee is asking you to consider a financial donation for food boxes for our two partner schools this month. This provides families in need some food for their children during the extra days and the Thanksgiving holiday long weekend when free/reduced lunch is not available. (Then in November we will collect for the Christmas vacation as in December we do the angel tree for a few school & Family Promise families.) Please mark you Emergency offering "ER" in the memo or drop it in the gold offering plate so marked. Thank you for being a blessing to others and hearing God's call.

## Usher Refresher Training

Sunday, Oct. 18

To help us all keep the important safety duties of the usher role fresh in our minds, we will have a very short usher meeting before coffee hour on Sunday, Oct. 18 right after the service. Please move in the pews to the front of the sanctuary for a ten-minute refresher. Our purpose is quickly recall the safety duties to protect our congregation while they worship. A handout will be provided. If you cannot attend, please contact Barb Clausen. This is important not only to maintain our security but also a requirement of our church insurance. Thank you!

## Reformation Sunday

Trinity Lutheran Church

October 25th at 10:00

The pickup choir meets at 8:30 that morning. Following services there will be a potluck, please bring a dish to share. Wear Red for Reformation!

## Ministry of the month: Pastor Appreciation

THANK YOUR PASTOR!

October is pastor appreciation month so if you want to be a part of the collection, please mark your special offering "Pastor Appreciation" and the council will be treating pastor to a surprise! Also, we will have a basket with a ribbon on it in the narthex to present to her the weekend of Oct. 18-19. A card with a personal note would mean so much to her and her family. She gives so much time and energy caring for our members and families! (Blank cards are available in the Faith Room in a file folder if you forget your own.)

## Upcoming Events

**Pet Blessing**
Sunday, October 4

**Council Meetings**
October 7 @ 12:00 Executive Meeting (Zoom)
October 21 @ 3:00 Council Meeting

**Small Seeds and Sprouts/ Youth Bible Study**
October 10
10:00 Small Seeds 11:00 Youth Bible 12:30 Sprouts

**Usher Training**
October 18 @ 11:15

**Mutual Ministry**
October 21 at 10:00

**Music and Worship**
October 22 @ 3:00

**Reformation at Trinity Lutheran Church**
Sunday, October 25th at 10:00

**All Saints Sunday**
Sunday, November 1

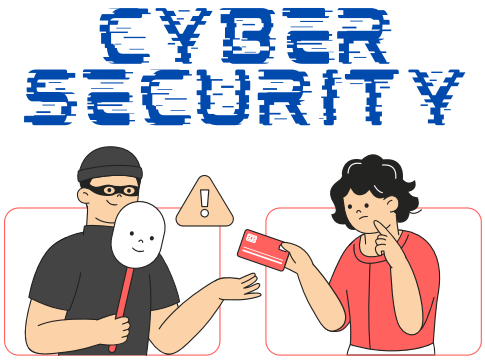
**Daylight Savings**
Sunday, November 1



# Pet BLESSING

*Sunday, October 4*

We welcome you to bring your well-behaved pets to our annual pet blessing held in the fellowship hall. Please contain any Creepy Crawly, scaled and feathered friends for this event. Pictures of non-travelling companions can be brought in to be blessed as well.




## Phishing Emails

We have received a number of emails that look like they are coming from members of our church and Pastor Susan. With all emails asking for assistance or links, check the senders email address and see if it lines up with what you know. Links from these false people can send you to malicious sites that can steal your information or download malware on your computer. One way of curbing this is to not respond to that email, but to start a new email with the contact information that you know is correct.




Thank you to all who brought pies – savory and sweet to the pie social. It made for a yummy day.

## Protecting Our God's Church

Please make sure the kitchen door remains locked except when loading/unloading supplies or welcoming people. The last person remaining in the building should make sure all doors are locked, kitchen doors shut, lights are off, and the security system is set. Work together to protect God's house just as you do your own home. Thank you!
Please see Ginger if you do not know how to set the alarm




## Bible Study Schedule

**Genesis 4:1-26, 5:21- 24**
October 2 and 4
**Genesis 5:28-32, Ch. 6-8**
October 9 and 11
**Genesis Ch 9 (ch.10), 11:1-9, (11) 11:26-32**
October 16 and 18
**No Study during Reformation**
October 23 and 25
**Genesis 12, Genesis 20:1-14**
October 30 and November 1
***Genesis 13:8-18, 14:8-24, 18:20-33, 19:1-29; 30-38 ****
November 6 and 8
**Genesis 15-17**
November 13 and 15

# Opportunities to Gather & Learn

## Women's Bible Study

*Meets Every Tuesday at 10:30*



Women's Bible Study is based through Gather Magazine, $9.95 for new subscribers.

We gather for prayers, cares, concerns, challenges, and celebration in the Faith room & on Zoom

## Moments at the Lake

Wednesdays @ 1:30



This is a wonderful opportunity for people to sit in the Word and have holy conversation while we discuss the scriptures for the following Sunday.

## DUCT TAPE

needs YOU

**Duct Tape meets every Thursday at 9:00 am with a coffee and donut break at 10:00**

## BIBLE STUDY



**Online Fridays @ 10:00 am**
**in person Sundays @ 11:15 am**
**Starting back in September**

## SMALL SEEDS and Sprouts



**Meets the 2nd Saturday of each month during the school year.**

**Please see details on page 5**

## CELEBRATE CELEBRATE CELEBRATE

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Tony Guerra | 19 | Patrick Murphy |
| 05 | Kathy Newton | 20 | Chris Engebo |
| 07 | Tori Gosch | 23 | Peggy Winston |
| 12 | Dana Hughes | 31 | Martha Sharp |



# ALL SAINTS' DAY

Please contact Ginger with the name and photo of your loved one that you would like remembered on this day. If you have submitted a person in the past, check to see that we have a photo

**NOVEMBER 1ST**

## Shopping List

Soup
Canned Veggies
Tomato Sauce
Mac & Cheese
Top Ramen
Canned Beans
Shampoo

FISH: November 6

## Bible Study

**Scoundrals... I mean founders of our faith. A walkthrough of the characters of Genesis**

Continuing through October
Fridays online at 10:00
Sundays[h] in person at 11:15
Schedule on page 3

## Welcome to our new children and youth programs!

We meet on the 2nd Saturday of each month. We are excited to begin this new chapter with the children and youth.
We will begin in October and carry on through May of next year.



| Small Seeds - Littles | Youth Bible Study | Sprouts - Confirmation |
|---|---|---|
| 10:00 - 10:45 am | 11:00 - 12:30 pm | 12:30 - 1:30 pm |

## Reformation Sunday



October 25th at 10:00
**Trintiy Lutheran Church**
2021 Washington Way
Potluck to follow

# MINISTRY VOLUNTEERS

| | October 4 | October 11 | October 18 | Reformation Trinity |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Greeter | Karen Langworthy | Youth | Phyllis Cavens | |
| Ushers | | | Harold Nunn | |
| Reader | | Youth | Tom Hughes III | |
| Communion Setup | Nancy Skora | Bob Reistroffer | | |
| Communion Assist | Nancy Skora | Pat Reistroffer | | |
| Powerpoint | | | | |
| Live Service | | | | |
| Financial Secretary | Barb Wilson | Mary Storm | Pam van den Driessche | Barb Wilson |
| Coffee Hour | | | Phyllis Cavens<br>Barb Clausen | |
| Volunteer Coordinator | Barb Clausen | Phyllis Cavens | | |

| ATTENDANCE | |
|---|---|
| **Sept** | **TOTAL** |
| **6** | **48** |
| **13** | **39** |
| **20** | **33** |
| **27** | |
| **AVG** | |

| **Offering to date September 9/23/26** | |
|---|---|
| **2025** | **2026** |
| $111,840 | $130,393 |
| **Expenses to date September 9/23/26** | |
| **2025** | **2026** |
| $132,578 | $123,410 |

| Name/Position/Term |
|---|
| 1. John Pelster (2029) |
| 2. Barbara Clausen (2027) |
| 3. Susan Shiu (Treasurer) |
| 4. Phyllis Cavens (2029) |
| 5. George Obermeyer (2029) |
| 6. Beth Grambo (2027) |
| 7. Tori Gosch (2028) |
| 8. P. Susan Dollinger (Pastor) |

**Bethany Lutheran Church**

**Council Meeting Minutes**– Thursday, September 10, 2026, 3:00 p.m.

**Attendance** -Beth Grambo, Susan Shiu, Tori Gosch, Phyllis Cavens, Pr. Susan Dollinger, George Obermeyer, & Barb Clausen

**Devotions and Prayer –** Barb Clausen

**Call to Order and President's Report –** Beth Grambo called the meeting to order at 3:12pm

- **Decisions made between council meetings**: None

**Agenda Changes-** Added CD decision and Council date change;

- Devotions for October 15-Beth Grambo

**Secretary's Report** – John Pelster

- August 13, 2026 minutes filed as edited.

**Treasurer's Report** – Susan Shui

**Synod Remittance** August $1230.26 *(Synod contributions inflated by members annual contributions)*

**Emergency Fund Report-** Venezuela Earthquake/ CO Wildfire 546.00 WA Wildfire $250

*Split due to member designations*

**Attendance for Averages:** August 44

| **August 2026** | | **2026 YTD** | | **August 2025** | | **2025 YTD** | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Income | Expense | Income | Expense | Income | Expense | Income | Expense |
| $35,150 | $19,034 | $123,949 | $111,043 | $15,416 | $18,674 | $90,891 | $104,949 |
| Exceeded by $16,116 | | Exceeded by $12,906 | | Fell Short by $3,258 | | Fell Short by $14,078 | |

*Note: Some members have given their RMD for the year, which makes the income inflated.*

**CD $20,000 Emergency Matures Oct. 15-**The best rate now will be 3.15% for 6 months. Current balance is $20,249. **It was moved and seconded to keep the interest in the total and re-invest. Motion carried.**

**Ministry Reports** –

- **Hospitality**: Pie Social on Rally Day, Sept. 13; Bring a pie to share!
- **Memorial:** No report
- **Worship/Music**:
  o Beth Grambo will preach at the service on October 18. Beth Grambo. Next lay-lead is Nov. 29th.
  o Rally Day is Sept. 13.
  o Pet Blessing on October 4.
  o Reformation service will be at Gloria Dei this year.
  o Committee will set a meeting date for latter September.
- **Youth/Service**:
  o The committee will meet September 30 at 10:30. All are welcome!
  o Small Seeds starts on October 10
- **Duct Tape Crew:** Pastor Susan Dollinger, George Obermeyer;
  o Cancel Duct Tape on September 17;
- **Stewardship**:
  o Met on September 9, with Nancy Skora, Phyllis Cavens, Renee Pelster, and Pastor in attendance.
  Renee regretfully will not be continuing on the committee, and Beth will replace her.
- **Mutual Ministry:** The committee will meet on October 21 at 10 a.m.
- **Women's Bible Study-**Study will commence on September 15. The new Gather magazine has been delivered.
- **Women of Bethany:** The next meeting is September 29.

- **Education-**
  - o The next Bible Study will be on the book of Genesis, titled "The Scoundrels…I mean the Founders…of our Faith." The study will meet on-line on September 18 at 10 a.m., and on Sunday September 20.
- **Minister's Report:** Pastor Susan
  - o Pastor took the week of August 25-27, which was good for stress levels
  - o Pastor Lydia from Stella has resigned effective August 31, and Pastor Craig from Trinity has retired effective September 30. St. Paul in Castle Rock is in the process of calling a pastor from Vancouver. Pastor Susan and Pastor Denise (from Gloria Dei) are the remaining ELCA pastors in the area.
  - o Lower Columbia Lutherans will continue to meet, but no activities or dates have been set at this time.
  - o Synod send all churches a stewardship letter asking us to prayerfully consider increasing our pledge when we do or budget.
- **Goal/Action Plan Progress Report:** Summer surge numbers are noted—*some people did not sign in!*

  Campfire & S'Mores-7 members, 2 guests; Film Festival-18 members, 1 guest

  Oyster Shell Art-7 members, 1 guest; Hymns & Sundaes-9 members, 5 guests

  Scams & Hacking-9 members, 6 guest; Portugal Pilgrimage- 10 members, 21 guests

  **Total Numbers: 64 members; 35 guests Goal purposes were fellowship and outreach!**

**Unfinished Business:**

- **Clipboard Volunteer Sign Ups-**Everyone please work on getting this done!
- **Water Department Bill ongoing saga—**Ginger continues to work diligently with the water department to get the issue resolved.
- **Usher Training**-there will be an usher training on October 18. Mandatory to refresh for insurance purposes!

**New Business:**

- **Building Security and Safety**-building left unlocked without security system set—please be careful! Call for help if needed!
- **Protocols for facility usage-** Barb will revised the policy as per discussion.
- **Council date change-Wednesday, Oct. 21 at 3:00** instead of the week earlier;

**Staff Report** –

- **Facility Use Approval-** Request from DKG December 17
- **Out of Offices Requests** (previously approved, information only)-

  September 22-23-Pastor's vacation;

  Sept. 24-5-Pastor's Continuing Ed (Leaders Away through First Christian Church)

**Adjournment-**Adjourned at 4:05.

October is Pastor appreciation month!

**Next Scheduled Meetings: Executive Committee Wednesday, October 7 noon; Council – Wednesday, October 21, 3:00 pm;**

# OCTOBER 2026

| SUN | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | 1<br>9:00 Duct tape<br>10:00 Coffee w/ DT<br>Ginger out of office | 2<br>**10:00 Bible Study**<br>6:00 Girl Scouts | 3 |
| 4 Sunday Service<br>**Pet Blessing**<br>9:30 Worship<br>10:30 Coffee Hour<br>**11:15 Bible Study** | 5 | 6<br>8:00 Breakfast Group<br>10:30 Women's Bible Study<br>6:00 Boy Scouts | 7<br>**12:00 Exec Meeting**<br>1:30 Moments @ Bethany | 8<br>9:00 Duct tape<br>10:00 Coffee w/ DT | 9<br>**10:00 Bible Study**<br>6:00 Girl Scouts | 10<br>**10:00 Small Seeds**<br>**11:00 Youth Bible**<br>**12:30 Sprouts**<br>WELCA Conv. |
| 11 Sunday Service<br>9:30 Worship<br>10:30 Coffee Hour<br>**11:15 Bible Study** | 12 | 13<br>8:00 Breakfast Group<br>10:30 Women's Bible Study<br>6:00 Boy Scouts | 14<br>1:30 Moments @ Bethany<br>*Pastor out of office- Dean's Meeting* | 15<br>9:00 Duct tape<br>10:00 Coffee w/ DT<br>**3:00 Council Meet** | 16<br>**10:00 Bible Study**<br>6:00 Girl Scouts | 17 |
| 18 Sunday Service<br>9:30 Worship<br>10:30 Coffee Hour<br>**Usher Training**<br>**11:15 Bible Study** | 19 | 20<br>8:00 Breakfast Group<br>10:30 Women's Bible Study<br>6:00 Boy Scouts | 21<br>**10:00 Mutual Ministry**<br>1:30 Moments @ Bethany | 22<br>9:00 Duct tape<br>10:00 Coffee w/ DT<br>**3:00 Music & Worship** | 23<br>6:00 Girl Scouts | 24 |
| 25 ***Reformation***<br>***10:00 Trinity Lutheran Church*** | 26 | 27<br>8:00 Breakfast Group<br>10:30 Women's Bible Study<br>6:00 Boy Scouts | 28<br>1:30 Moments @ Bethany | 29<br>9:00 Duct tape<br>10:00 Coffee w/ DT | 30<br>**10:00 Bible Study**<br>6:00 Girl Scouts | 31 |

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GOD'S BLESSINGS TO



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